Igor Kolesnikov

CV

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EDUCATION

UC Berkeley, Department of Political Science — Berkeley, US
PhD in Political Science — 2022 – 2028

National Research University Higher School of Economics — Moscow, Russia
BA in Political Science, Political Analysis subfield — 2018 – 2022

National Research University Higher School of Economics — Moscow, Russia
Minor, Intelligent Data Analysis — 2019 – 2021

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

1. Eva Davoine, Joseph Enguehard, Victor Gay, and **Igor Kolesnikov**. **Mapping the Grandes Gabelles in Early Modern France.** *Explorations in Economic History* (2026).

2. Maxim Slav, Elena Smyslovskikh, Vladimir Novikov, **Igor Kolesnikov**, and Andrey Korotayev. **Deprivation, Instability, and Propensity to Attack: How Urbanization Influences Terrorism.** *International Interactions* (2021).

WORK IN PROGRESS

1. **Territorial Control in Civil Wars**, with Christopher Blair, María Ballesteros, and Austin Wright.
   - Revise and resubmit, *World Politics*

2. **Surviving the Commons: Property Regimes and Political Control** (Job Market Paper).
   - Presented at the CPD Workshop, UC Berkeley (2025); Summer Workshop in the Economic History and Historical Political Economy of Eurasia (2026)

3. **Taxed into Office: Enfranchisement and State Capacity in the Russian Empire**, with Otto Kienitz.
   - Presented at the Summer Workshop in the Economic History and Historical Political Economy of Eurasia (2023, 2026); Berkeley–Stanford Bay Area Economic History Workshop (2024); Stanford Historical Social Science Workshop (2025); Andrea Mitchell Center for the Study of Democracy Graduate Workshop (2025); Economic History Mini-Conference, California Center for Population Research, UCLA

4. **The Political Costs of Taxation**, with Eva Davoine and Joseph Enguehard.
   - Selected for the NBER Summer Institute, Political Economy (2025)
   - Best Ph.D. Student Paper Award, *International Tax and Public Finance* (2025)
   - Finalist, CESifo Award in Public Economics (2025)
   - Presented at EHA (2022, single-authored poster); SDU HEDG Workshop (2024); EHS (2024); FRESH Louvain (2024); ASREC Europe (2024); LSE Economic History Graduate Seminar

- Available at taxobservatory.eu

5. **Guns, Garrisons, and Growth: Revisiting State Formation in Africa**, with Leonardo Arriola, Martha Wilfahrt, and Yosef Tadesse.
   - Presented at MPSA (2024); APSA (2024, 2025)

6. **Legacies of Incorporation: Land Tenure and State Capacity in Ethiopia**, with Leonardo Arriola, Martha Wilfahrt, and Yosef Tadesse.
   - Presented at APSA (2026)

7. **Spreading Insurgency: Evidence from the Russian October Revolution**, with Vladimir Novikov.
   - Presented at the Summer Workshop in the Economic History and Historical Political Economy of Eurasia (2023); VWHPE (2024); MPSA (2024)

8. **Elite Selection: Party Composition and Purges in the Soviet Union**, with Liza Brover.

FELLOWSHIPS AND GRANTS

- APSA Doctoral Dissertation Research Improvement Grant (2026)
- IHS Humane Studies Fellowship (2026)
- James Goldgeier Fellowship for International Research (2026)
- Reinhard Bendix and Allan Sharlin Fellowship (2026)
- ISEEES Academic Year Dissertation Fellowship (2025)
- BESI Political Economy Research Award (2023–2024, 2024–2025)
- BESI Political Economy Conference Travel Grant (FY 2024)
- ISEEES Summer Research Fellowship (2023, 2024)
- Simpson Pre-Dissertation Fellowship (2024)
- Designated Emphasis in Political Economy Scholars Small Research Grant (2023)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Graduate Student Instructor with Sean Gailmard — UC Berkeley
Formal Models of Political Science — Spring 2026

Graduate Student Instructor with Sean Gailmard — UC Berkeley
Game Theory in the Social Sciences — Summer 2025

Graduate Student Instructor with Stephanie Zonszein — UC Berkeley
Advanced Topics in Causal Inference — Spring 2025

Graduate Student Instructor with Jason Wittenberg — UC Berkeley
Introduction to Empirical Analysis and Quantitative Methods — Fall 2024

Course Assistant — Higher School of Economics
History of Political Thought, Political Theory, Political Sociology — 2019 – 2022

Tutor HSE Lyceum
Elective course preparing school students for Social Science Olympiads 2019 – 2021

Teacher, National Academic Competition for Schoolchildren preparatory courses
Department of Social Sciences 2018 – 2020

RESEARCH ASSISTANCE

- **Logic(s) of Historical Persistence**, for Jason Wittenberg
- **Repressions of the USSR High Military Command**, for Alexey Zakharov
- **Regional Variation in Restrictions and Transfers in Russia during the Covid-19 Pandemic**, for Ekaterina Borisova
- **Electoral Turnout Decisions in the Aftermath of the 2018 Armenian Revolution**, for Cemal Eren Arbatli and David Gomtsyan

WORK EXPERIENCE

Center for Advanced Governance (cpur.ru) Moscow, Russia
Junior Data Analyst 2021 – 2022

International Center for the Study of Institutions and Development, HSE
Research Assistant 2020 – 2021

Department of Theoretical Economics, HSE
Research Assistant 2020 – 2021

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE AND PRESENTATIONS

- Organizer, Development and Political Economics Conference (Spring 2026)
- Graduate Student Organizer, Formal Theory Group
- Presenter, Economic History Mini-Conference, California Center for Population Research, UCLA
- Presenter, Stanford Historical Social Science Workshop
- Presenter, APSA (Fall 2024)
- Presenter, MPSA (Spring 2023, Spring 2025)
- Presenter, Bay Area Student Economic History Workshop (Spring 2023)
- Presenter, 47th Annual Berkeley–Stanford Conference on Slavic, East European, and Eurasian Studies
- Presenter, Conference of the Society for Institutional & Organizational Economics (Summer 2022)
- Presenter, Exhibition of Scientific Achievements (VDNKh) (Summer 2022)

SKILLS

Programming	Python, R, JAGS, SQL
Research tools	RStudio, Google Colab, QGIS, DBeaver Crowd-sourcing platforms (Toloka, Amazon Mechanical Turk)
Empirical methods	Panel data, time series, Bayesian statistics, regression discontinuity, difference-in-differences, IV, decision trees, NLP
Languages	Russian (native), English (fluent), French (beginner)